

Sony VRD-VC20 DVDirect

Sony has recently introduced the world's first hybrid DVD recorder, capable of burning DVDs with or without a PC—the Sony VRD-VC20 DVDirect. It works as an external 16x DVD burner when connected to the PC, and supports all the common formats.



The real advantage of the DVDirect is that it connects to various video sources such as VCRs, analogue and digital video cameras. DVDirect synchronises with a connected DV Camcorder. Recording and pausing can be controlled with the camera buttons. Also, if your video camera's batteries die out, the recording is paused and you can resume recording after charging! There is no video output on the device, and the video camera needs to have a video display if you want to monitor what you're recording.

Company **Rashi Peripherals Pvt Ltd**

Price **Rs 19,990**

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Web site **www.sony.com**

Rating 

MSI MegaView 588

Let's Entertain!

The MSI MegaView 588 is a great personal entertainer. The 3.5-inch, wide view angle QVGA LCD provides vivid video playback. It supports WMV, WMA, MPEG-4, DivX, WAV, MP3, JPEG and GIF. MSI has also provided a transcoding utility to convert videos into formats playable on the player.

The device sports a 20 GB hard disk, a recorder function that allows you to record videos in MPEG-4, a microphone to record short memos, and an FM tuner. It is also equipped with USB 2.0 On-The-Go, and an SD/MMC card reader.

The Li-Ion rechargeable battery lasted us 3.5 hours with video and six hours with audio playback. The audio quality of the earphones is acceptable, and sound from the inbuilt speaker is exceptionally clear.



Company **Micro-Star International**

Price **Rs 24,500**

Phone **011-51758808**

Web site **www.msi-india.com**

Rating 

New & Notable

Yes MMP8 Portable DVD Player

Watch All You Want!

The Yes MMP8 is a portable DVD player with a difference—it features a slate form factor and is disc-based. There is no internal memory to store media. Measuring 22 x 15.3 x 2.6 cm and weighing close to 700 grams without the battery, the device is a bit bulky—but makes up on features and performance.

The MMP8 supports a variety of media formats, from standard DVD, VCD and MP3 to picture CD and even MPEG4 and DivX. Yes, that's right—you can also view DivX movies burnt onto CD or DVD. CD-RW and DVD-RW discs are also supported. Where performance is concerned, we found no issues—the MMP8 played all the media formats we tried out.

The glossy black front fascia sports a decent-sized 7-inch screen. The controls are located on both sides as well as on the top edge, and the optical drive can be accessed from the rear. The included rechargeable lithium battery pack affixes to the rear right.

Audio output is through an integrated speaker and through the bundled earphones. A unique feature is the availability of a USB port and a Flash card slot. The MMP8 can play supported media formats—including audio, video and images—straight off any USB device such as USB drives, digital cameras, MP3 players and digital



camcorders, and also off MMC, SD and Memory sticks. You can also connect the player to your TV and use the bundled wireless slim remote.

SPDIF digital output is also provided, so you can enjoy 5.1 surround sound on an existing external Dolby Digital or DTS amplifier. Apart from a standard power adaptor that powers the player and charges the battery, you get a car charger for when you take the device with you on a road trip.

The player displays an Explorer-like interface to list the music and video tracks on a disc. Menu navigation is easy enough, and the remote allows you to specify settings such as the TV system (PAL/NTSC), TV type (4:3/16:9), password, and more.

The bundled 4200 mAh battery lasted about 3.5 hours with DivX playback—enough for even a long movie. Apart from being somewhat bulky and carrying a slightly high price tag, this is a decent product to consider if you don't want to miss out on your entertainment on a vacation.

Company **Thakral Computers Pvt Ltd**

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Rating 